

The graphic features a large, central, irregular shape in a golden-yellow color. Overlaid on this is a larger, semi-transparent shape in a magenta color. The text 'Unit 8 Agreement' is centered within the golden-yellow shape. The entire composition is set against a light cream background and enclosed within a dashed magenta border. Several smaller, solid-colored ovals in yellow, magenta, and orange are scattered around the central shapes.

Unit 8

Agreement

[8.1](#)

[8.2](#)

[8.3](#)

[8.4](#)

[8.5](#)

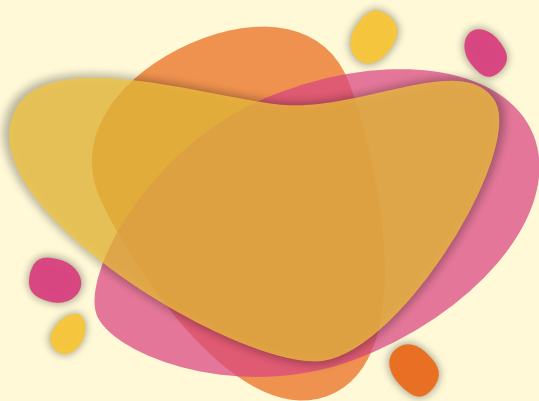
[8.6](#)

[8.7](#)

[8.8](#)

[8.9](#)

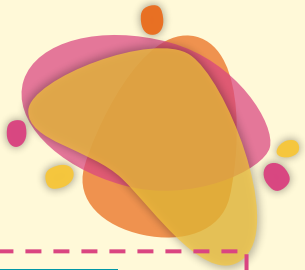
[8.10](#)



8.1 Singular and Plural



8.1 Singular and Plural



 A **verb** must **agree** with its **subject**. A **singular subject** requires a **singular verb**, and a **plural subject** requires a **plural verb**.

Singular Subject

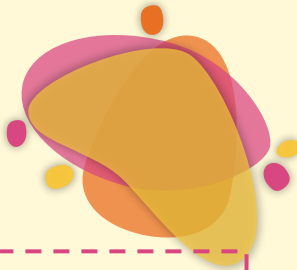
Add an **-s** or **-es** to the present tense **verb** if the **subject** of the sentence is **singular**.
When you add **-s** or **-es** to a **verb**, be sure to change the spelling when necessary.

The dog **stands** near the road. (Add -s)

She **catches** the bus every morning. (Add -es)

It **hurries** around the tree. (Add -es and change spelling)

8.1 Singular and Plural



Singular Subject

Do **not** add **-s** to the **verb** if the **subject** is **plural** or if the subject is one of the **pronouns I or you**.

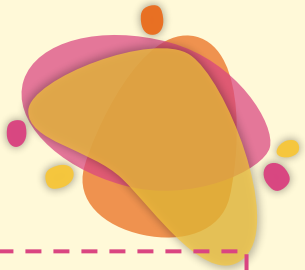
The musicians **buy** sheet music.

They **play** softball every Saturday.

I **celebrate** my birthday tomorrow.

You **bake** delicious brownies.

8.1 Singular and Plural



The forms of the verbs **be**, **have**, and **do** have special **singular** and **plural** forms that are easily confused.

✎ Use **is**, **was**, or **does** if the **subject** is **singular**.

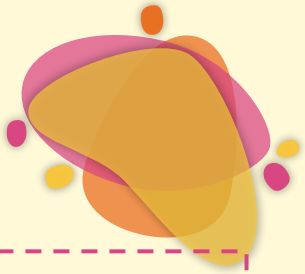
Susanna **is** our tennis instructor.

The boy **was** in the wrong line.

She **has** three sisters.

He **does** his chores daily.

8.1 Singular and Plural



✎ Use **are**, **were**, **have**, or **do** if the **subject** is **plural**.

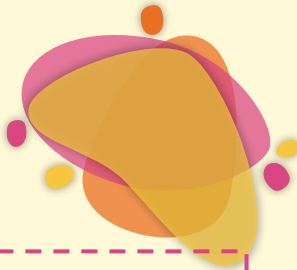
The girls **are** very hungry.

People **were** late for the game.

We **have** the wrong answer.

They **do** jumping jacks after lunch.

8.1 Singular and Plural



 Use **am**, **was**, **have**, or **do** if the **subject** is the pronoun **I**.

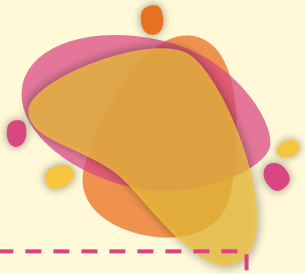
I am tired.

I was early.

I have a brother.

I do dishes after breakfast.

8.1 Singular and Plural



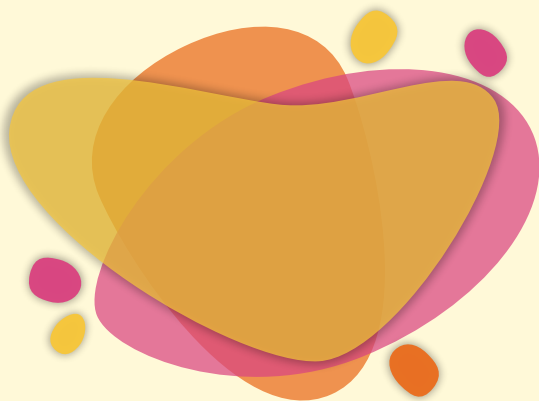
✎ Use **are**, **were**, **have**, or **do** if the **subject** is the pronoun **you**.

You **are** strong.

You **were** the winner.

You **have** a hole in your sock.

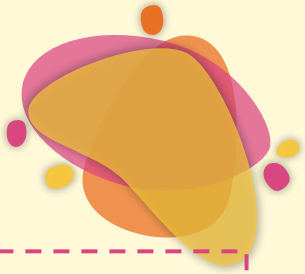
You **do** perfect cartwheels.



8.2 Agreement with Compound Subjects



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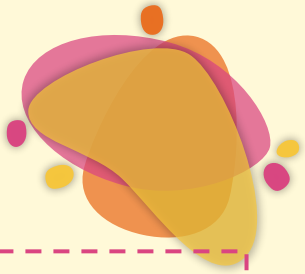
✎ A **compound subject** includes **two** or **more subjects joined** by a conjunction. There are different rules of **agreement** to follow for **compound subjects**.

When the parts of a **compound subject** are joined by **and**, the **compound subject** is generally **plural** and requires a **plural verb**.

Trish and Thomas **hurry** to the library.
(plural subject) (plural verb)

In this example, the **singular** nouns **Trish** and **Thomas** are joined by **and**. This makes the subject **plural** and requires the **plural** verb **hurry**.

8.2 Agreement with Compound Subjects



More examples:

My sister and my mother **are** nervous.

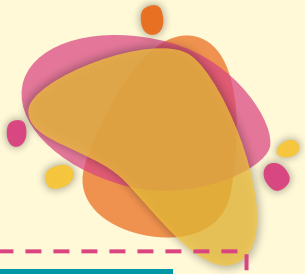
The boxes and letters **arrive** daily.

Two men and one woman **sing** in the band.

The television and radio **were** old.

The boys and girls **hear** music.

8.2 Agreement with Compound Subjects



✎ When the parts of a **compound subject** are joined by **or**, **either/or**, or **neither/nor**, use the form of the **verb** that agrees with the **nearer subject**.

Trish or Thomas **hurries** to the library.

(singular subject) (singular verb)

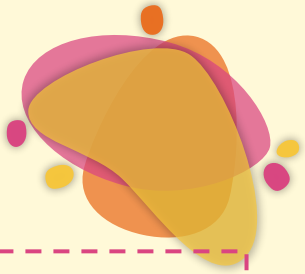
In this example, the **singular** subject **Thomas** is nearer to the **verb**. It requires the **singular** verb **hurries**.

Neither the cups nor the plate **belongs** on the table.

(singular subject) (singular verb)

In this example, the **singular** subject **plate** is nearer to the **verb**. It requires the **singular** verb **belongs**.

8.2 Agreement with Compound Subjects



More examples:

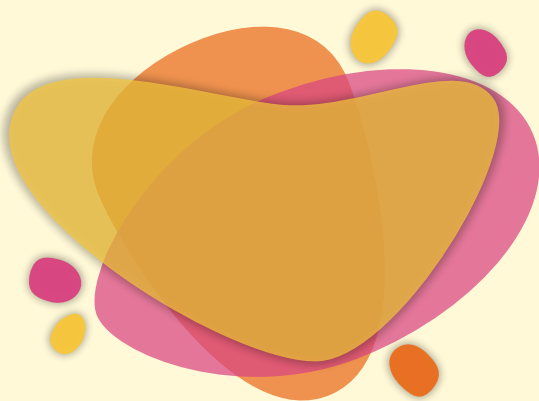
My sister or my mother **is nervous.**

Either the boxes or the letters **arrive daily.**

Two men or one woman **sings in the band.**

Neither the television nor the radio **was old.**

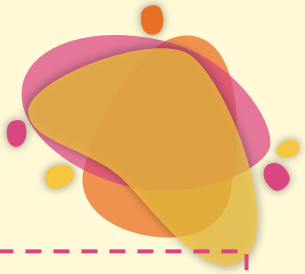
Either the boys or the girls **hear music.**



8.3 Subjects in Inverted Sentences



8.3 Subjects in Inverted Sentences



In most sentences, the **subject** comes **before** the **verb**.

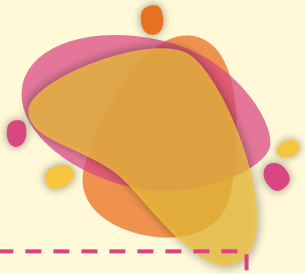
✎ In an **inverted sentence**, however, the **verb** comes **before** the **subject**. Even though the **subject** follows the **verb** in an **inverted sentence**, the **subject** and **verb** must **agree**.

Normal: The cat **hides** under the blankets.

Inverted: Under the blankets **hides** the cat.

In both sentences **cat** is the **subject** and **hides** is the **verb**. Notice in the **inverted sentence** that the verb **hides** comes **before** the subject **cat**. The **subject** and **verb** **agree** in both sentences.

8.3 Subjects in Inverted Sentences



More examples:

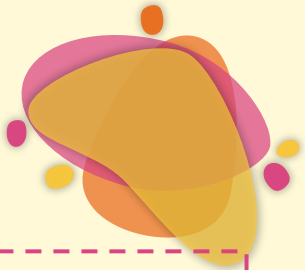
Across the river **is** the house.

Across the river **are** the houses.

Beside the garage **sits** on squirrel.

Beside the garage **sit** two squirrels.

8.3 Subjects in Inverted Sentences



Because an **inverted sentence** often **begins** with a **prepositional phrase** (such as the previous examples), the **object** of the **preposition** can be easily **mistaken** for the **subject**.

On the couch **rest** the children.

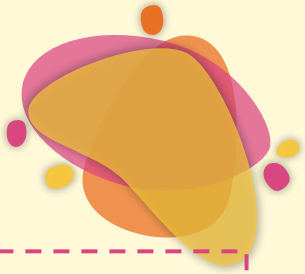
Prepositional phrase

Verb

Subject

Do **not** mistake the **object** of the preposition **couch** for the **subject**. The **subject** in this sentence is the noun **children** and the verb **rest** must **agree** with it.

8.3 Subjects in Inverted Sentences



More examples:

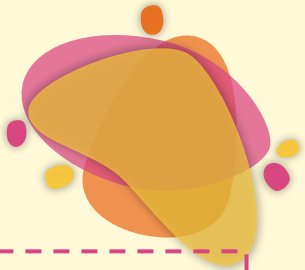
Through the trees **runs** the dog.

Along the beach **walk** the boys.

Between the two girls **sits** Robert.

Into the deep water **swim** the whales.

8.3 Subjects in Inverted Sentences



 Inverted sentences often begin with the word there, here, or where. These words are almost never the subject of a sentence.

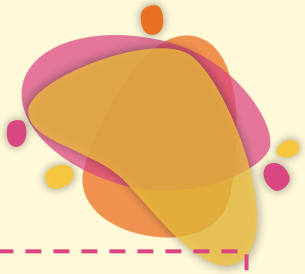
Here is your hat.

There are my mittens.

Where are your shoes?

In these examples, the subject and verb also agree.

8.3 Subjects in Inverted Sentences



More examples:

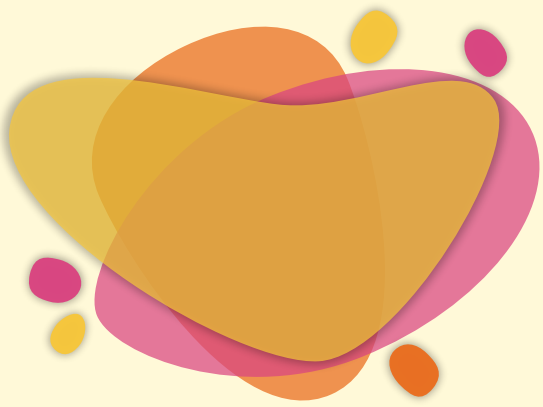
Here **is** the bus.

Here **are** the directions for the game.

There **is** a slide at the park.

There **are** no cookies in the pantry.

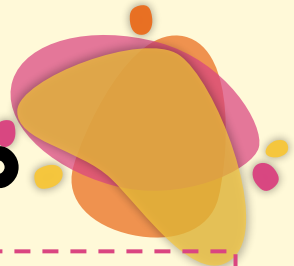
Where **is** my money?



8.4 Words Between the Subject and Verb



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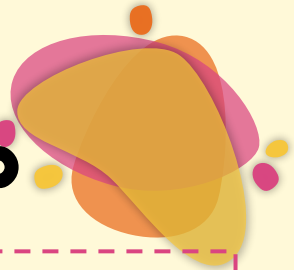


✎ Sometimes a **phrase** comes between a **subject** and its **verb**. This, however, does **not** affect the **subject-verb agreement**.

The girls in the museum **sit** quietly.

In this example, the **plural** subject **girls** agrees with the **plural** verb **sit**. The prepositional phrase **in the museum** does **not** affect the **subject-verb agreement**.

8.4 Words Between the Subject and Verb



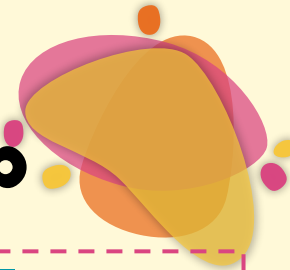
More examples:

The dinner *for the children* **smells** delicious.

Flowers *in our garden* **grow** quickly.

The computers *at the library* **run** slowly.

8.4 Words Between the Subject and Verb

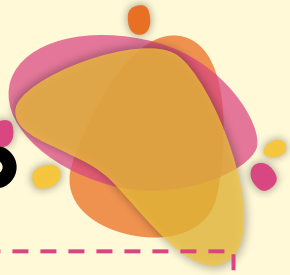


✎ Sometimes a **clause** separates a **subject** and its **verb**. Again, this does **not** affect the **subject-verb agreement**.

The man *who lives next door* **drives** carefully.

In this example, the **singular** subject **man** agrees with the singular verb **drives**. The clause **who lies next door** does **not** affect the **subject-verb agreement**.

8.4 Words Between the Subject and Verb

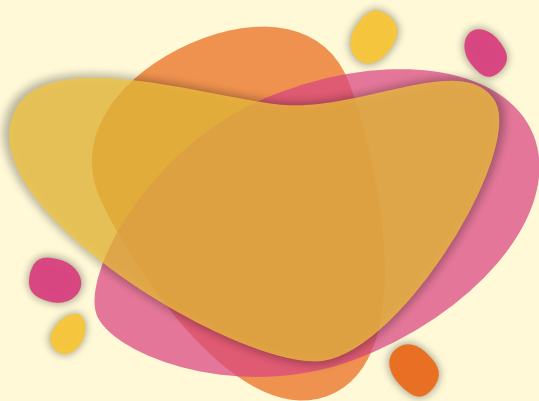


More examples:

The dog *that jumped the fence* **barks** uncontrollably.

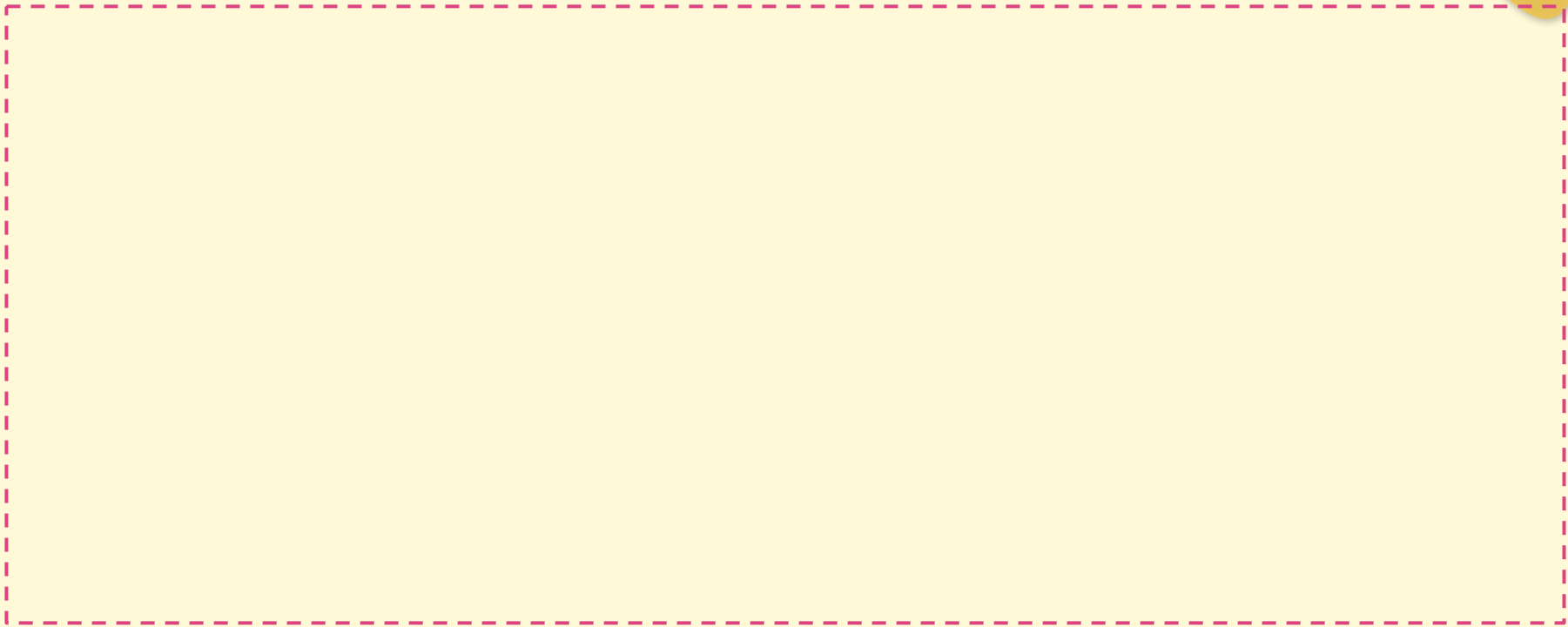
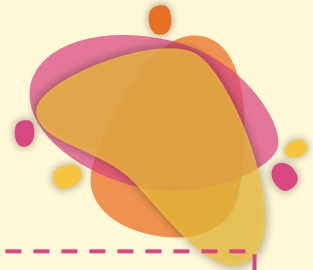
The boys *who just joined the team* **practice** every day.

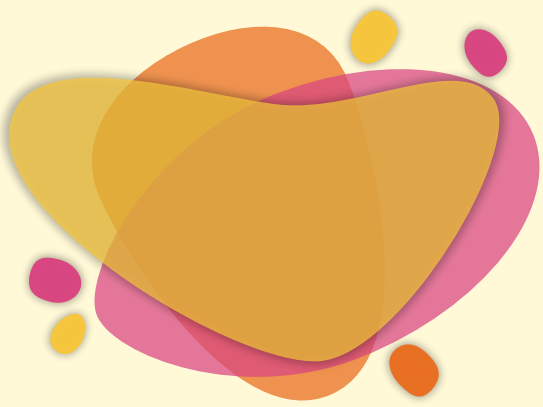
The car *that Uncle Thomas* **bought** was expensive.



8.5 Collective Noun Agreement

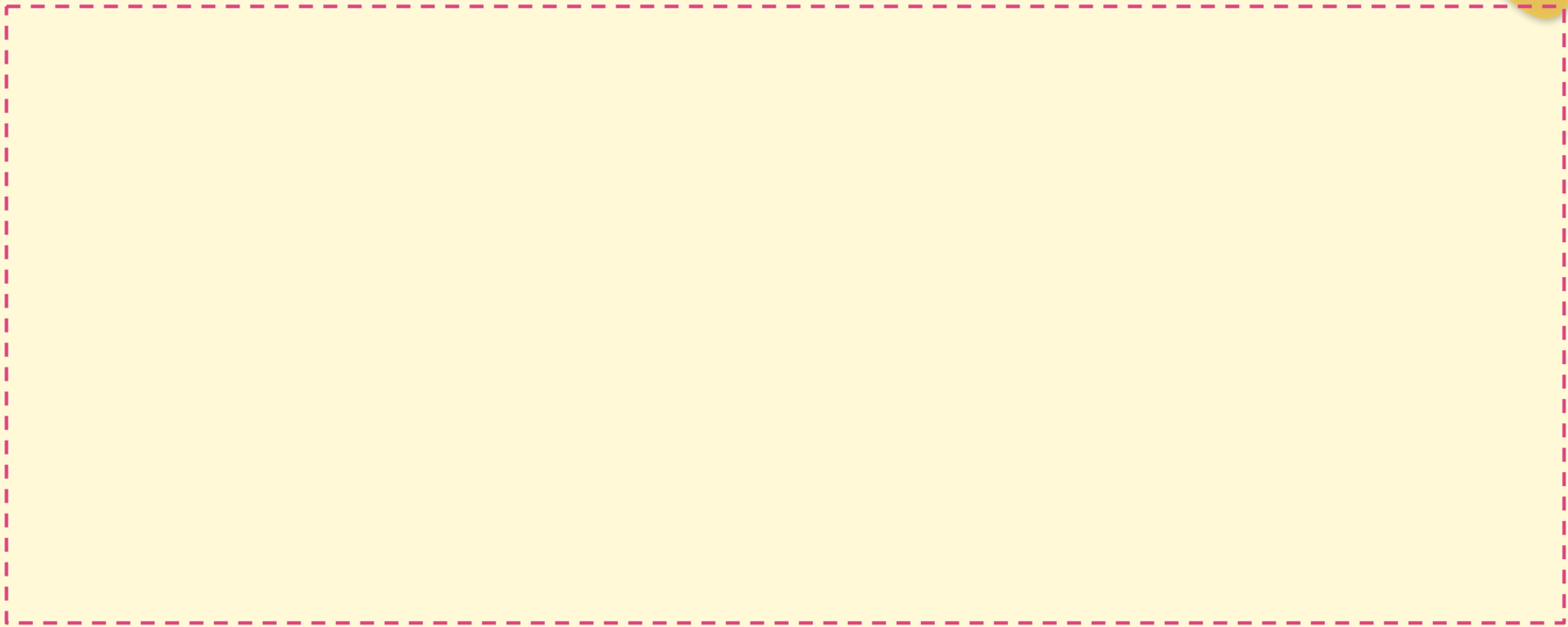
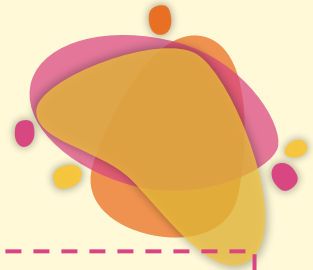


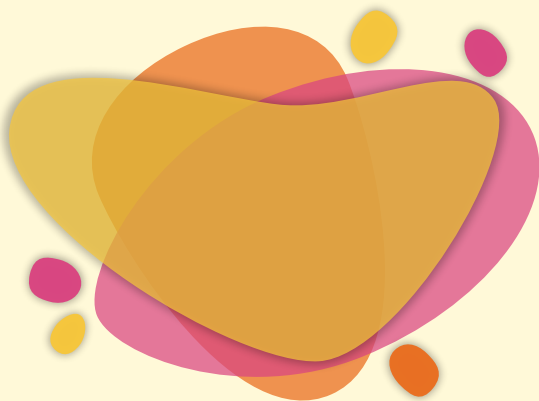




8.6 Words Stating Amount

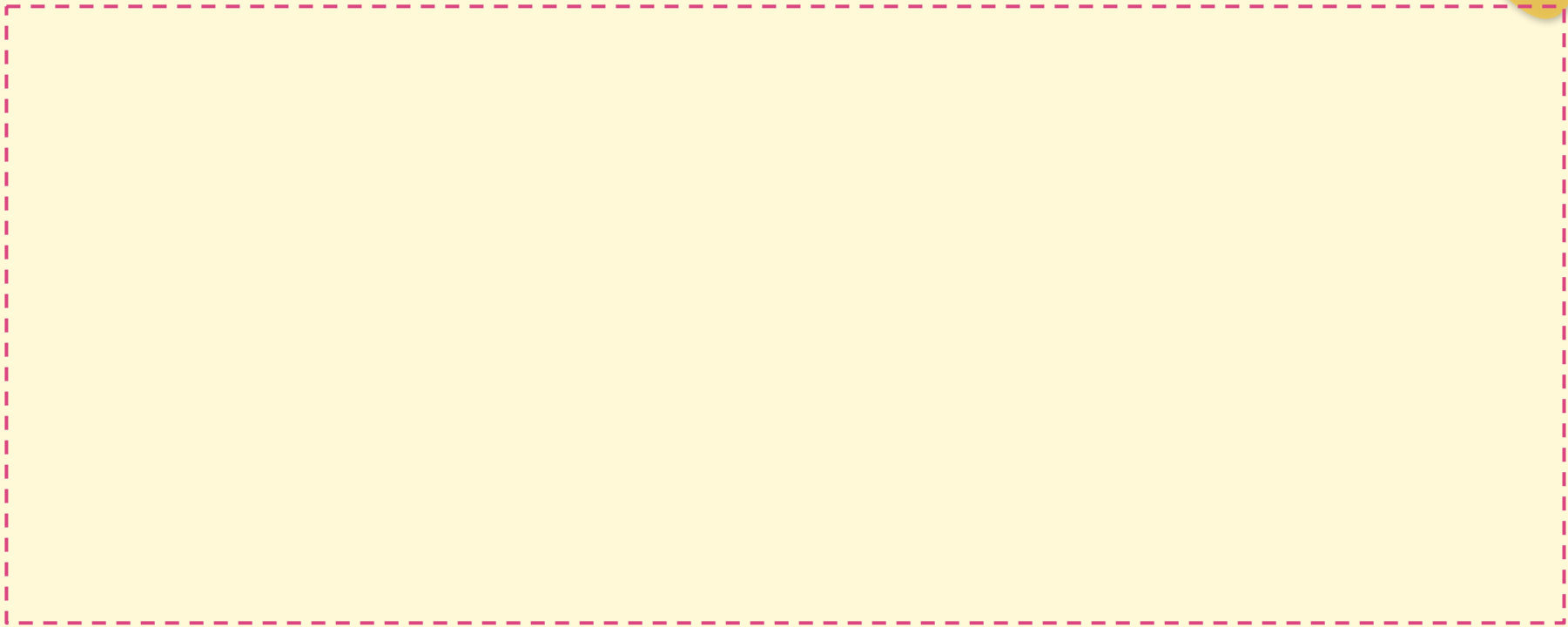
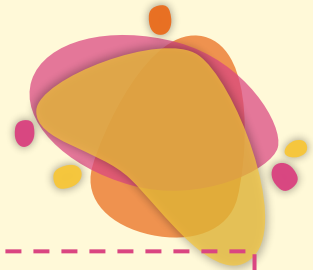


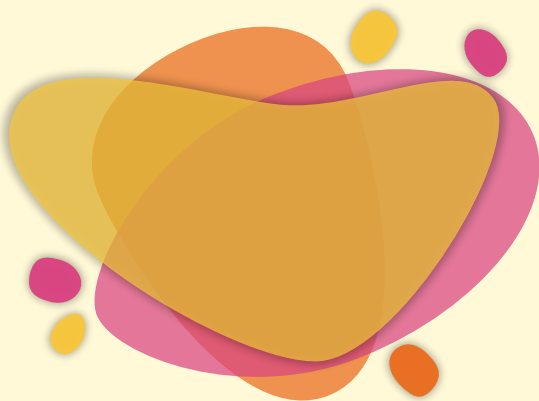




8.7 Titles as Subjects

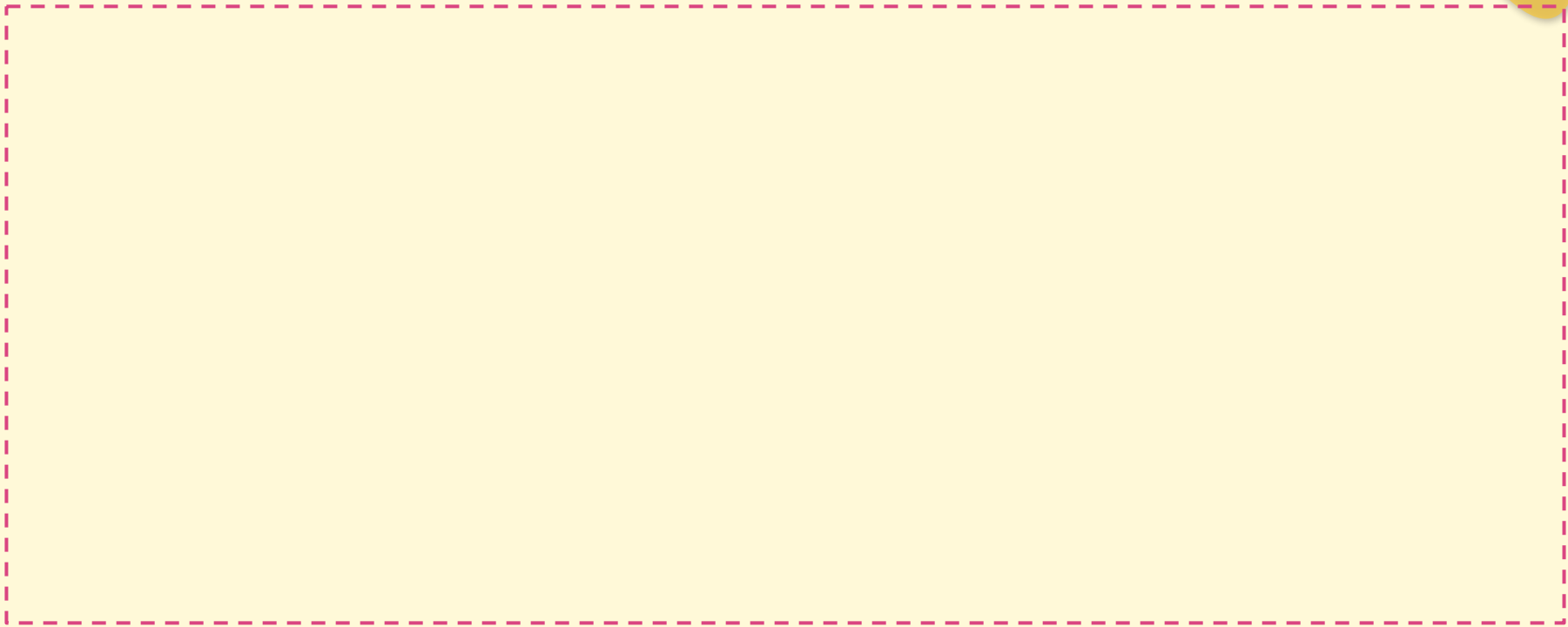
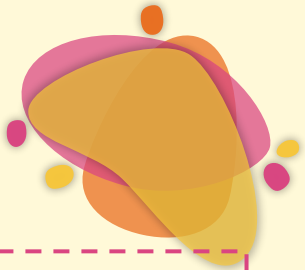


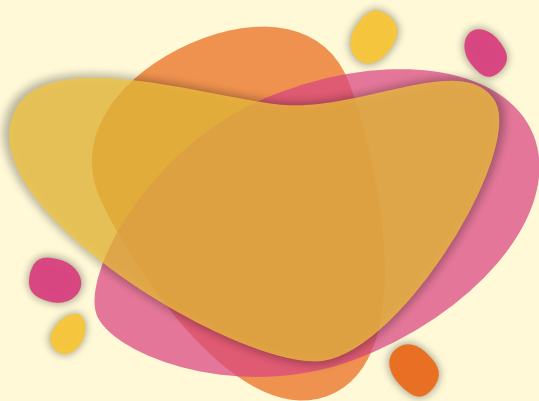




8.8 Plural-Looking Subjects

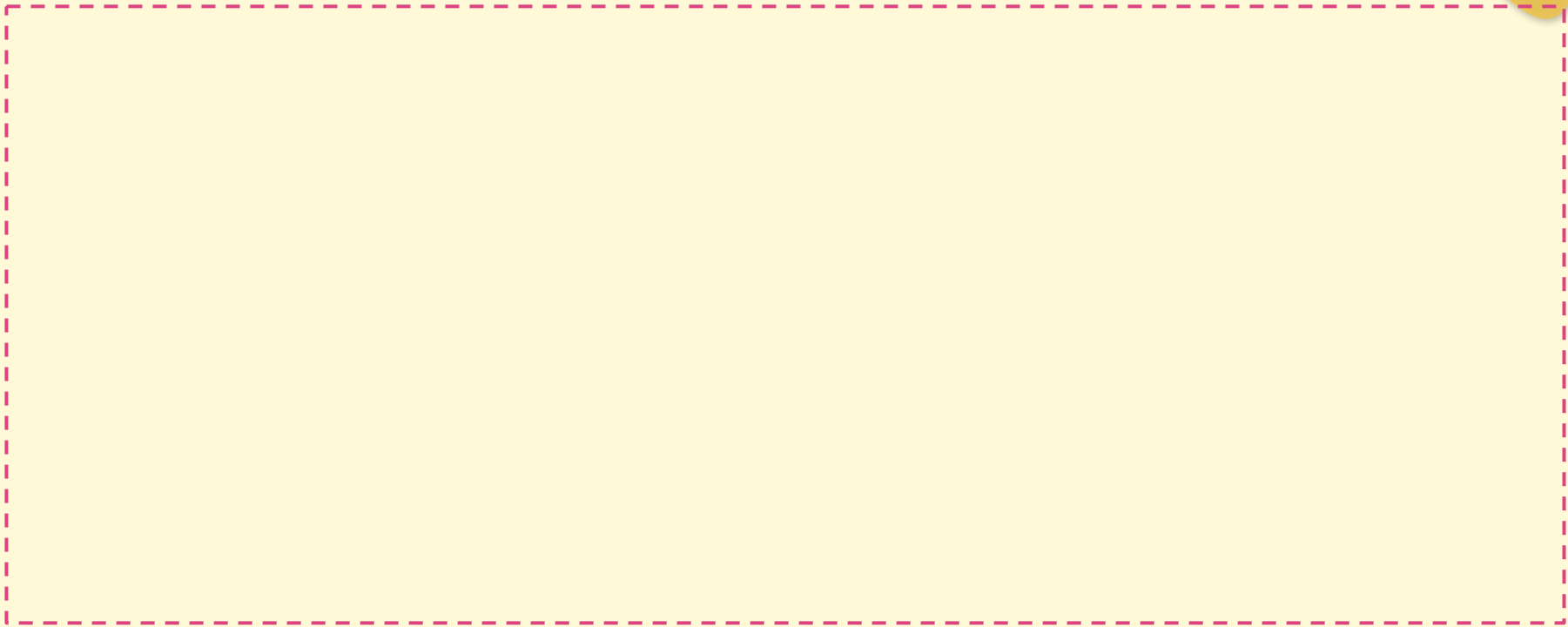
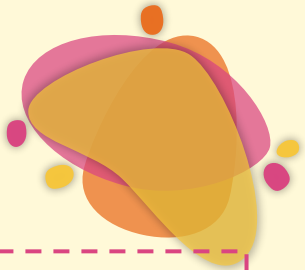


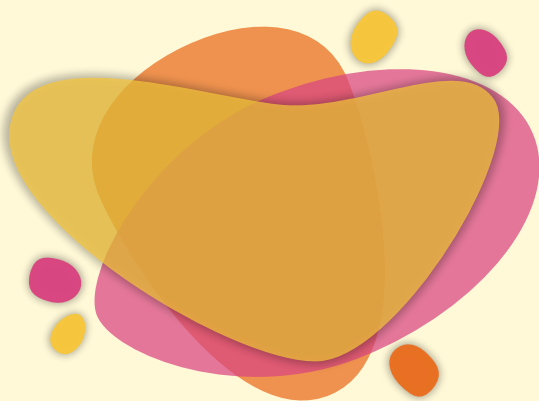




8.9 Pronoun and Antecedent Agreement







8.10 Indefinite Pronoun Agreement



